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Topic 9: Coaching for High Performance

Practical Models and Application



Dr Quyen Dang
Head of Management Department
The Business School

SESSION FLOW

Here's How We'll Spend the Day

09:00–09:15	Opening: Coaching Pain Points	Kick-off
09:15–10:15	What Type of Manager Are You?	LO1
10:15–10:45	Always-On Managers and the Myths	LO1
10:45–11:00	Morning break	Break
11:00–12:00	Understand and Become a Connector	LO2
12:00–13:30	Lunch	Lunch
13:30–14:30	High Performers and Personal Growth	LO3
14:30–14:45	Afternoon break	Break
14:45–16:00	Coaching Detective Role Play	LO1–LO3
16:00–16:30	Detailed Action Plan and Close	LO4

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Consultant, Human Resource Management and International Business

Education:

- **Doctor of Philosophy** in International Human Resource Management, *University of Technology Sydney, Australia (2019)*
- **Master of Commerce** in Human Resource Management, *Macquarie University, Australia (2016)*
- **Bachelor** of International Business and Economics, *Foreign Trade University, Vietnam (2011)*

Awards:

- Best Phenomenon-based Paper Award, 2025, Journal World of Business (A*)
- Women In Academy of International Business Awards for Women Scholars (2019, Denmark)
- University of Technology Sydney PhD Scholarship, 2016 – 2019

Research interests:

- International Business
- Human Resource Management
- University-Industry Knowledge Collaboration

ACTIVITY

What challenges do you face?

10 minutes

1. Open Mentimeter using the link or code shared
2. Select every challenge that feels familiar
3. Notice the class pattern on screen
4. Choose one real challenge to carry through today

REFLECT

Which challenge would make the biggest difference if you handled it better?

Mentimeter

Open Menti to edit

Replace this slide

Add Menti slides

Which challenges do you face as a first-time manager?

menti.com

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0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Low ownership	Repeated mistakes	Defensive responses	Growth plateau	Overload or burnout	Cross-team dependency	Always asks for the answer

Waiting for participants

PART 1

What type of manager are you?

Your result is a pattern – not a permanent identity.

Notice the pattern. Choose the response.



ACTIVITY

Take the four-manager quiz

15 minutes

1. Answer for your typical behaviour – not your ideal behaviour
2. Choose one response for every situation
3. Work independently; there are no ‘good’ answers
4. Count how many A, B, C and D responses you selected
5. Keep your result private until invited to discuss

REFLECT

Where might pressure change your answer?

QUIZ RESULT

Read the pattern – do not force the label

Mostly A	**Teacher**	I coach from my own expertise.
Mostly B	**Always-On**	I coach frequently and across many topics.
Mostly C	**Connector**	I diagnose, coach selectively and connect.
Mostly D	**Cheerleader**	I encourage employees to own development.

Tie? Keep both tendencies.

FOUR MANAGER TYPES

Four distinct ways managers approach coaching

Each style brings value – but creates different development experiences for employees.

THE TEACHER MANAGER



- Gives advice-led feedback and directs employee development.
- Draws on a strong track record as an individual contributor.
- Trusts their approach because of their experience and expertise.

THE ALWAYS-ON MANAGER



- Gives frequent feedback and drives employee development.
- Goes the extra mile with in-the-moment coaching – even beyond their own experience.
- Takes responsibility for driving all employee development.

THE CHEERLEADER MANAGER



- Empowers employees to own their development.
- Gives positive feedback and tends to avoid criticism.
- Does not obsess over detail when coaching or giving feedback.

THE CONNECTOR MANAGER



- Creates a positive team environment and gives targeted feedback.
- Prioritises relationship quality over feedback quantity.
- Connects employees to others when expertise sits elsewhere.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

REFLECTION

Your result is a starting point – not a verdict

1. **What strength does this style give you?**
2. When does that strength become too much?
3. Which situation triggers your default?
4. What response will you experiment with today?

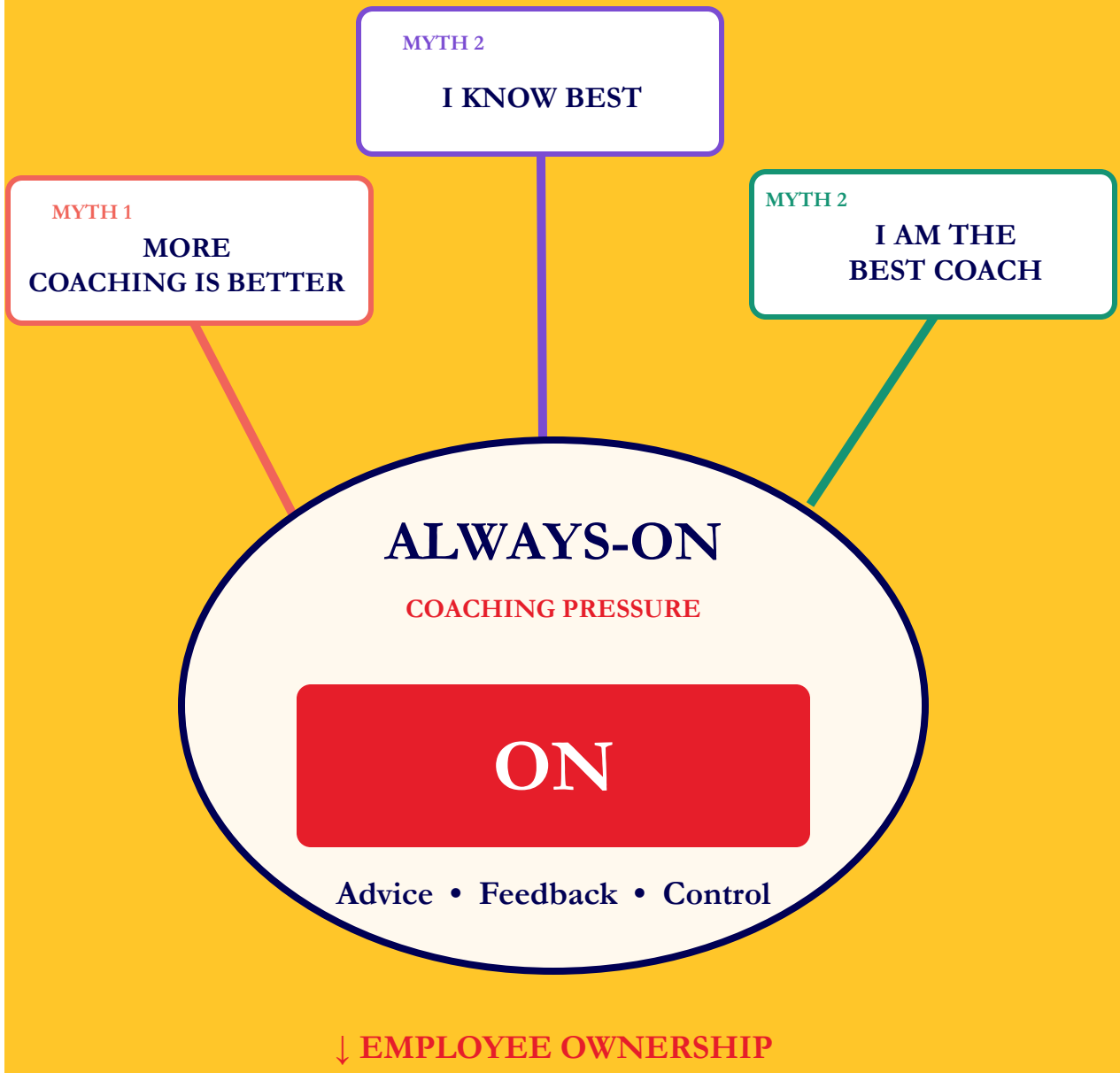
A style becomes a trap when it replaces diagnosis.

PART 2

Three myths keep Always-On managers switched on

More coaching can feel helpful – while quietly reducing ownership.

Let's challenge what sounds true.

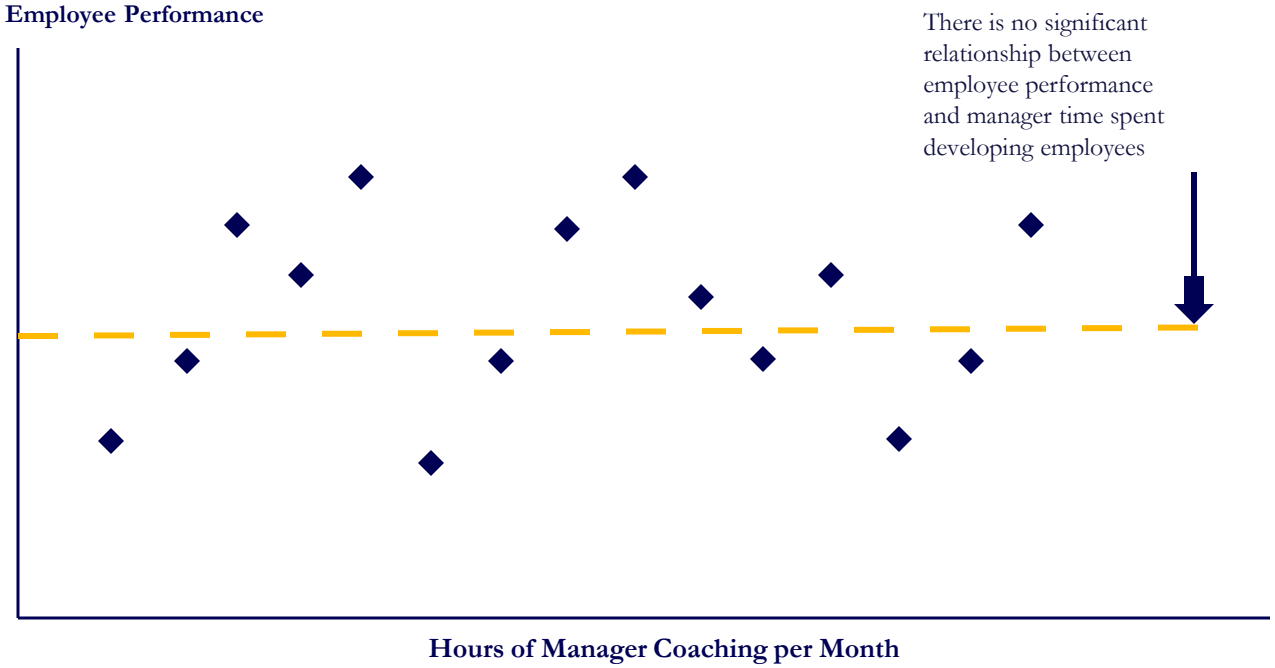


MYTH 1

More coaching time and feedback automatically improve performance

The evidence: coaching volume is not the same as coaching quality.

Employee Performance Versus Hours of Manager Coaching



Number of respondents = 7,309 employees

Source: 2017 Gartner Manager Effectiveness Survey

THE MYTH

"The more time I spend coaching and giving feedback, the better my employee will perform."

WHAT THE RESEARCH SAYS

There is no significant correlation between time spent coaching and employee performance.

WHY IT BACKFIRES

Constant guidance becomes a "feedback firehose": employees lose focus, second-guess themselves and feel less ownership.

MANAGER MOVE

Decouple coaching time from coaching quality. Coach selectively – on the few issues that matter most.

MYTH 2

Managers are expected to always know what is best for employees

Top-down development advice is risky when the manager does not fully understand the work or the person.

18%

of employees believe their manager understands their work

THE PROBLEM

Always-On managers often set the development agenda from the top down. If their understanding is incomplete, even well-meant advice may be irrelevant.

WHY IT BACKFIRES

Premature assumptions about capability, motivation or aspiration can send the employee toward the wrong goal—and weaken trust and ownership.

RECALIBRATE WITH CURIOSITY

What motivates you? • **How do you prefer to learn?**
What work gives you energy? • **What are you trying to become?**

MANAGER MOVE **Diagnose before directing. Replace assumptions with probing questions about motivators, preferences and aspirations.**

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

MYTH 3

Managers are always the best source of coaching and feedback

No manager can be the expert, teacher and development resource for every need.



WHY THE MYTH PERSISTS

Managers feel pressure to provide an answer. Always-On managers assume some guidance is better than no guidance – even outside their expertise.

THE BUSINESS RISK

Outdated, partial or incorrect advice can misdirect effort, slow decisions and create significant negative business impact.

COACH DIRECTLY

Lean in where you have credible, relevant strength.

CREATE A CONNECTION

Find the colleague, peer or expert who can teach this better.

MANAGER MOVE **Know your strengths and boundaries. Lean in when credible; defer and connect when someone else is the better coach.**

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

MYTH-BUSTING TAKEAWAY

Effective coaching is relevant, targeted and connected

The answer is not “coach more.” It is choosing the right development response for this person, now.

1

QUALITY OVER QUANTITY

Focus coaching on the few issues that materially improve performance.

2

CURIOSITY BEFORE ADVICE

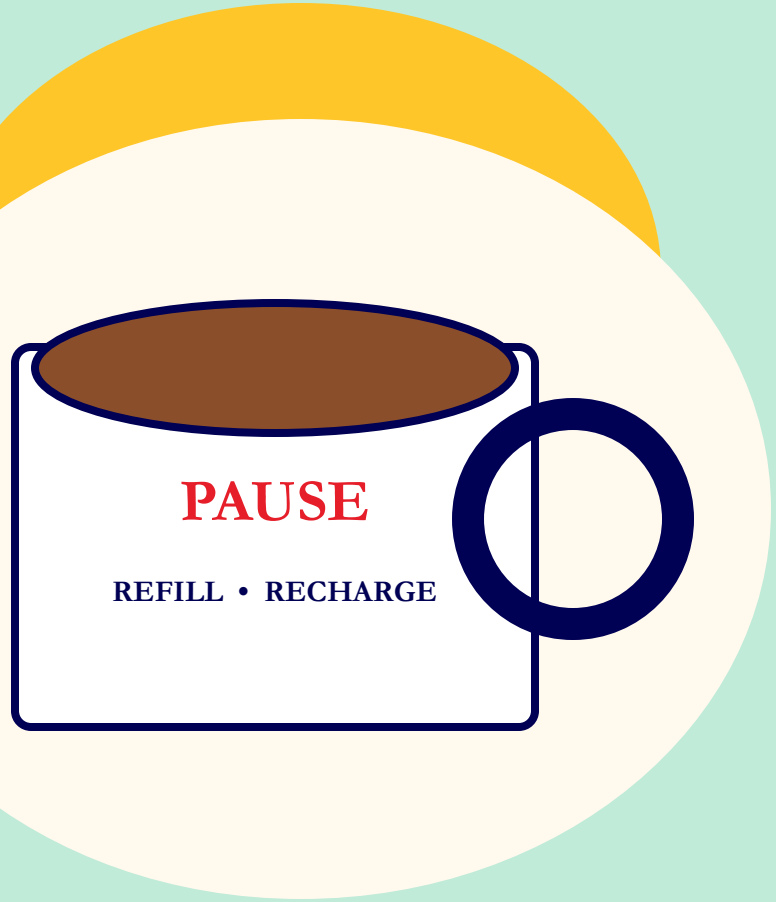
Understand the employee’s work, motivation, preferences and aspirations.

3

EXPERTISE OR CONNECTION

Coach where credible; connect the employee when another source is stronger.

PAUSE → DIAGNOSE → COACH OR CONNECT



MORNING BREAK

Take a proper breather.

Stretch. Refill

BACK AT 11:00

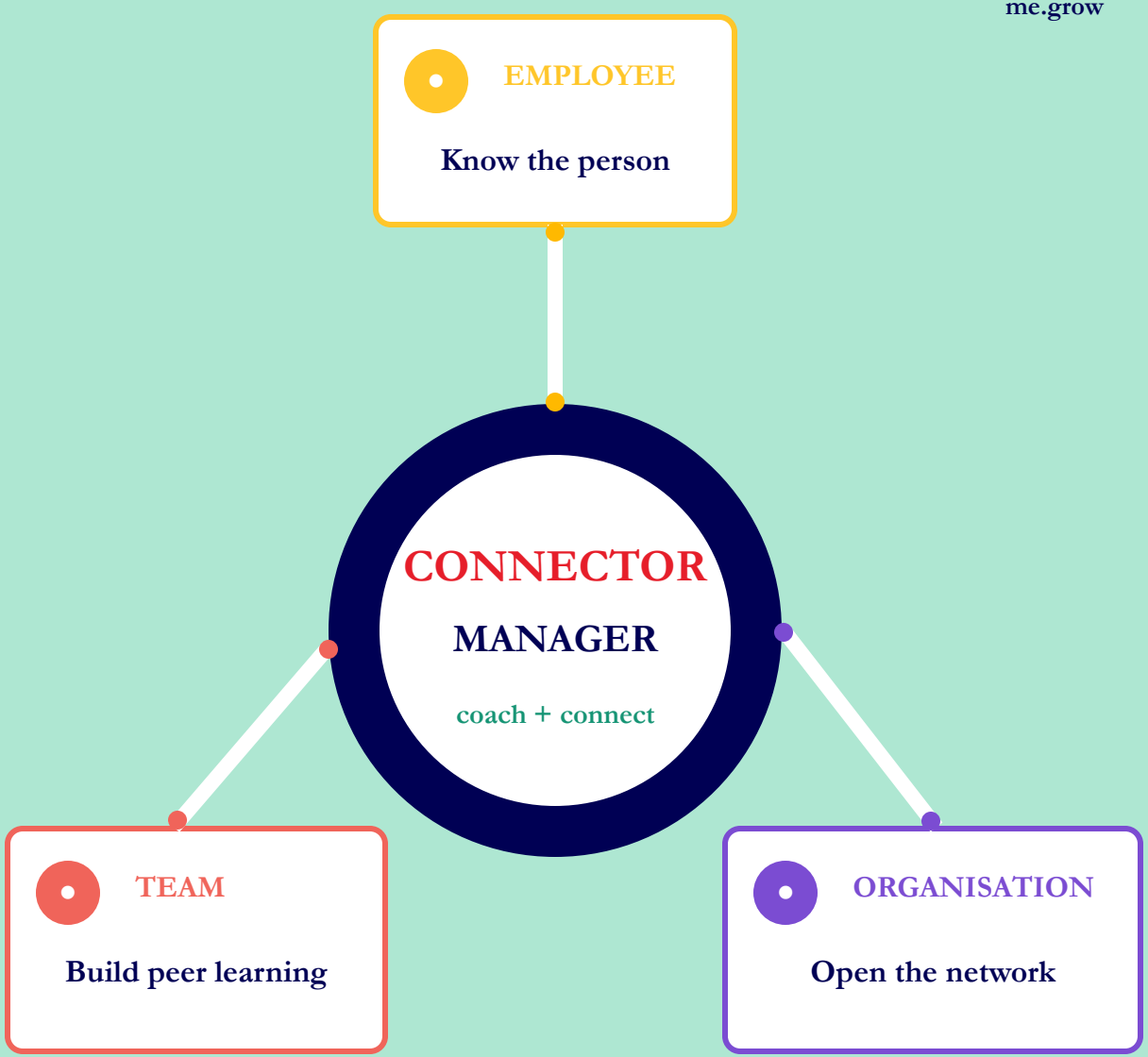
NEXT Understanding and becoming a Connector Manager

PART 3

The Connector Manager

Understand the person.
Coach where useful.
Connect deliberately.

Development is a network – not a solo act.



RIGHT PERSON • RIGHT SUPPORT • RIGHT MOMENT

CONNECTOR MINDSET

Five qualities that make better connections possible

Connector Managers combine curiosity and courage with self-awareness, diverse learning and disciplined generosity.



1

CURIOUS ABOUT PEOPLE AND IDEAS

Genuinely learns each person's context, history and motivation. Asks more questions, seeks opinions and consults evidence or experts before acting on assumptions.



2

COURAGE IN CHALLENGING SITUATIONS

Raises difficult performance truths, gives tough feedback and makes unpopular decisions when needed. Uses conflict and difference to remove roadblocks and strengthen the team.



3

TRANSPARENCY AND SELF-AWARENESS

Knows strengths, limits and emotional impact; takes responsibility and asks for help. Shares gaps openly so others can contribute expertise and trust can grow.



4

OPEN TO LEARNING FROM DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVES

Learns from any source—peers, junior colleagues and specialists—not only hierarchy or seniority. Values expertise over title and invites others to influence the answer.



5

JUDICIOUS GENEROSITY

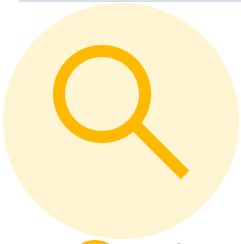
Shares credit, information, access, power and belief to help others succeed. Gives the support that unlocks growth, while connecting people instead of rescuing or becoming overloaded.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

CONNECTOR QUALITY 1 / 5

Curiosity turns assumptions into useful questions

Connectors stay genuinely interested in people and ideas – and keep discovering before deciding.



CURIOUS ABOUT PEOPLE AND IDEAS

SEE THE WHOLE PERSON

Learn their context, history, motivations, joys, worries and past experience – not only the task in front of them.

QUESTION BEFORE ASSUMING

Ask more questions than other manager types. Test what you think you know before giving feedback or making a development decision.

SEARCH BEYOND YOURSELF

Solicit opinions, research the issue and consult colleagues or experts as a normal step before proceeding with a plan.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

EXAMPLE – OLARK

"If I really knew you…"

Kimberly Bringas encouraged managers to form a fuller picture of each team member – their home life, hobbies, joys and worries. Employees completed this sentence so managers could understand their unique context, history and current situation, rather than relying on pre-existing biases.

TRY IT AT ZALO

Ask one direct report to complete the sentence. Listen for what fuels – or slows – their development.

KEY TAKEAWAY Curiosity improves coaching relevance because the manager understands before advising – and discovers who else may help.

CONNECTOR QUALITY 2 / 5

Courage in challenging situations

Connectors face difficult truths, withstand personal risk and create the conditions for others to act.



COURAGE IN CHALLENGING SITUATIONS

ADDRESS THE HARD ISSUE

Give tough feedback, make unpopular decisions and name performance gaps clearly—without attacking the person.

USE CONFLICT CONSTRUCTIVELY

Mediate disagreement and use differences in skills, opinions, backgrounds and experience to understand the problem and strengthen the team.

CEDE CONTROL WHEN NEEDED

Remove roadblocks and redistribute information or decision-making to the people closest to the work—even when doing so feels personally risky.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

EXAMPLE – STANLEY McCHRYSTAL

"Radical transparency"

Facing a fast-moving opponent in Iraq, McChrystal saw that the traditional command structure was too slow. He introduced a daily video conference for every rank – sharing what leaders had learned and, importantly, what he did not know. Information moved faster, gaps became visible and decisions shifted closer to the expertise.

TRY IT AT ZALO

During a product incident, say what you know – and don't. Let the closest expertise decide.

KEY TAKEAWAY **Courage is not command. It makes truth, information and expertise safe to move through the team.**

CONNECTOR QUALITY 3 / 5

Transparency and self-awareness

Connectors understand their strengths, limits and impact—and make those realities visible to others.



KNOW YOURSELF – AND LET OTHERS SEE

KNOW YOUR CURRENT STATE

Recognise strengths and weaknesses across skills, tasks and situations. Take responsibility for emotions and ask for help when needed.

MAKE GAPS VISIBLE

Openly share development needs and limits of expertise so others can contribute – rather than pretending to have every answer.

UNDERSTAND YOUR IMPACT

Notice how your actions and communication affect others. Invite feedback, respond with empathy and adjust when change is needed.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

EXAMPLE – ANJALI SUD

"I didn't know a thing about toys."

At Amazon, Sud led veteran toy-industry buyers despite coming from investment banking. She openly acknowledged their deep expertise – and her own lack of it. By asking questions, listening and 'walking a mile in their shoes,' she earned trust and created a complementary working dynamic that helped grow the business.

TRY IT AT ZALO

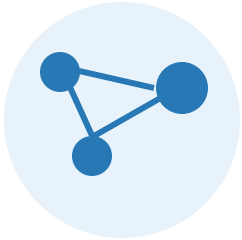
When leading outside your expertise, name the gap, recognise the team's strengths and ask what you need to learn from them.

KEY TAKEAWAY Transparency builds trust: know your edge, show your gaps and invite others to contribute what you lack.

CONNECTOR QUALITY 4 / 5

Openess to learning from different perspectives

Connectors are diverse learners: they seek useful insight from any source, regardless of title or seniority.



LEARN FROM ANYONE – NOT ONLY AUTHORITY

LOOK BEYOND HIERARCHY

Seek advice, expertise and feedback without being constrained by job title, level or seniority. Peers and junior colleagues can be powerful teachers.

EXCHANGE IDEAS WIDELY

Interact with everyone around you and create an egalitarian learning climate where people can challenge, coach and develop one another.

MATCH THE BEST PERSPECTIVE

Choose development connections for their relevant skills and expertise—not their rank. Diverse viewpoints improve learning and innovation.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

EXAMPLE – ED CATMULL

"Anyone should be able to talk to anyone, at any level."

At Pixar, Catmull challenged hierarchy and silos. He spent time watching junior engineers use unfamiliar techniques. Although they initially thought he was scrutinising them, he asked them to teach him. His humility and curiosity helped democratise learning and made unexpected expertise easier to find.

TRY IT AT ZALO

Ask: Who understands this best – even if they are newer or more junior? Invite that person to teach the team.

KEY TAKEAWAY Expertise has no job grade: Connectors seek the best perspective, then make learning travel across the team.

CONNECTOR QUALITY 5 / 5

Judicious Generosity

Connectors share what empowers others – credit, information, power and belief – while protecting ownership and capacity.



GIVE WHAT UNLOCKS OTHER PEOPLE'S SUCCESS

SHARE MORE THAN TIME

Give credit, information, power and belief. Recognise other people's achievements and build a sense of shared success instead of internal competition.

TRUST PEOPLE TO ACT

Show belief through meaningful leeway and decision space. Outward trust empowers people to contribute, take ownership and unite around a higher goal.

HELP WITHOUT BECOMING THE BOTTLENECK

Coach when your experience is useful; otherwise connect people to the right source. Meet the need without donating your time to every request.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

EXAMPLE – WARREN BUFFETT

Trust becomes generosity when it creates room to act

Buffett describes trust as one of an organization's most powerful forces: find trustworthy managers and give them substantial leeway. This is judicious generosity – sharing authority and belief with capable people so they can succeed, rather than holding control or competing for credit.

TRY IT AT ZALO

Before helping, ask: What would empower ownership – credit, context, authority, belief, coaching or the right connection?

KEY TAKEAWAY Be generous with what creates capability – not with rescue that makes you the answer to every problem.

ACTIVITY

Always-On or Connect-On?

25 minutes •

1. Place the 12 trigger cards on your A1 sheet
2. For each trigger, write the Always-On response on pink
3. Write the Connector response on green
4. Choose the funniest realistic Always-On response
5. Choose the most effective Connector response

REFLECT

Which trigger most activates your Always-On reflex – and why?

ACTIVITY DEBRIEF

Control reacts. Connection creates ownership.

ALWAYS-ON

Increases control
Adds advice
Checks more often
Solves the visible problem

→

CONNECTOR

Pauses
Diagnoses the need
Chooses coaching or connection
Returns ownership

How could the Connector response improve ownership and performance?

BECOMING A CONNECTOR

Performance grows through three deliberate connections

Begin with the employee, multiply development through the team, then extend access across the organization.



Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

EMPLOYEE CONNECTION

(Really) get to know your employees

The foundational connection: understand the whole person before deciding what coaching, feedback or development they need.



DIAGNOSE THE PERSON – NOT ONLY THE PROBLEM

1 **Overinvest in diagnosis.**

Build trust and listen for needs, interests, aspirations, context and readiness. Diagnose the whole person before selecting support.

2 **Coach the person, not the problem.**

Flex coaching to the individual's needs, personality and receptivity. Help them uncover strengths and what they really want—not just solve today's task.

3 **Be positive, but be prepared to be tough.**

Prioritise strengths-based feedback, but give specific, critical feedback when it is most needed and the employee is ready to use it.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

EXAMPLE - 100+ NEW GRADUATES

Scale understanding before scaling coaching

A professional-services leader was responsible for onboarding and developing more than 100 graduates. She resisted giving constant feedback to everyone. Instead, she held monthly office hours and used targeted questions to understand each employee deeply – then provided more relevant development at the right time.

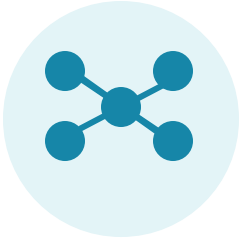
ASK AT ZALO	**What excites you about your role? • What change would make you happier? • What do you need most from me now?**

KEY TAKEAWAY **Spend coaching time differently: listen deeply upfront, then target feedback to the person, moment and readiness.**

TEAM CONNECTION

Make development a team sport

Turn the team's diverse skills, experiences and perspectives into a peer-development ecosystem – not a manager-only service.



TURN TEAM DIVERSITY INTO DEVELOPMENT

1. **Use motivators to tailor the team environment.**

   Understand what engages people individually and collectively. Shape projects, communication and ways of working so everyone moves toward common goals.

2. **Identify and embrace individual differences.**

   Encourage distinct opinions, backgrounds and experiences. Use those differences to build trust, develop new skills and improve team outcomes.

3. **Make peer skill sharing a ritual.**

   Model vulnerability by sharing your own skill gaps. Make strengths and development needs visible, then create repeatable peer teaching moments.

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

EXAMPLE - EACH ONE, TEACH ONE

Every teammate teaches one skill

In this ritual, every team member – including the manager – names a skill they can teach. Strengths become visible, and employees arrange development sessions directly with the colleague who can help. The manager creates the environment; the team supplies the learning network.

5 EMPLOYEES	→ nearly 25 possible team connections
TRY AT ZALO	Run a 15-minute 'I can teach / I want to learn' exchange.

KEY TAKEAWAY The manager does not need to match every learner—build the conditions for teammates to develop one another.

ORGANISATION CONNECTION

Ensure better, not just more, connections

Broker the best-fit development relationship, prepare the employee to use it and revisit the value created afterwards.

BROKER CONNECTIONS THAT FIT THE NEED

1 BECOME MAPMAKERS

Locate relevant skills inside or outside the organization. Use key contacts to find expertise – not merely the closest or most senior person.

2 DEVELOP WARM-UP AND COOL-DOWN ROUTINES

Prepare employees to extract value before a meeting; afterwards, reflect on learning, application and whether the connection should continue.

3 MODEL BEST-FIT CONNECTIONS

Coach in your strengths, acknowledge your limits and connect employees to others when their expertise better serves short- or long-term needs.

EXAMPLE - A 15-PERSON RETAILER

Look beyond the obvious network

A digital marketing manager needed to master e-commerce but had no suitable peer internally. The CEO looked outside the company and identified 'benevolent outsiders': peer firms, technology partners and customers. The goal was not more introductions – it was access to the expertise that matched the employee's need.

BEST-FIT SOURCES	**Peers • Partners • Customers**
TRY AT ZALO	**Name the capability first – then map who can best develop it.**

Source: Gartner; adapted from The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

KEY TAKEAWAY Connector value comes from fit and follow-through—not network size or the number of introductions made.

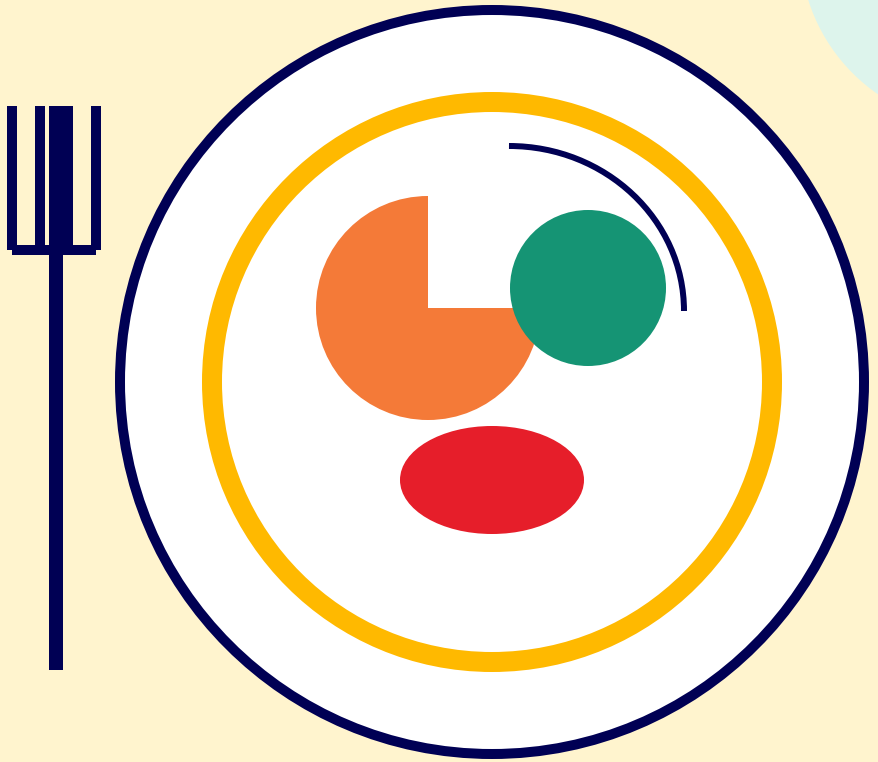
LUNCH BREAK

Refuel. Recharge. Return curious.

Please **bring yourself** back too – not only your coffee.

BACK AT **13:30**

Next up • Building high performers and personal growth strategy



GOOD ENERGY IN

Great coaching out

PART 4

Build high performers by diagnosing before developing

The visible problem is a clue – not the conclusion.

1 **OBSERVE**
What do you notice?

2 **DIAGNOSE**
What is really happening?

3 **DEVELOP**
What support fits?



NEXT • Two practical tools for root-cause diagnosis and development readiness

TOOL 1

Root-cause diagnosis: five places to investigate

1

KNOWLEDGE

Do they have the information and priorities?

2

SKILLS

Can they perform the work?

3

MOTIVATION

What creates or drains effort?

4

CAREER

How do strengths and aspirations fit?

5

ENVIRONMENT

What workload, resource or system blocks success?

Source: The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

Source: The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

TOOL 1

Overinvest in Diagnosis:

Manager Tool Kit for Conducting a Root Cause Analysis



LOOK FOR THE CAUSE, NOT THE SYMPTOM

K

1 KNOWLEDGE

OBJECTIVE **Assess whether employees are missing critical information to do their jobs.**

QUESTIONS TO TEST

- Do you have all the information and resources you need?
- Do you know what to prioritise?
- Do I give you enough feedback on how you're performing?

S

2 SKILLS

OBJECTIVE **Identify whether employees are missing skills and how they're addressing those gaps.**

QUESTIONS TO TEST

- How well does your skill set align with your current role?
- Have you completed similar work in the past?
- Which learning experiences have you already tried?

M

3 MOTIVATION

OBJECTIVE **Understand what motivates employees day to day at work – and what drives them outside work.**

QUESTIONS TO TEST

- What motivated you to take this role?
- What do you find most exciting about your role?
- Do you feel inspired to succeed here?

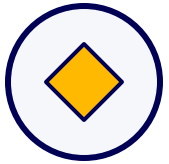
LISTEN FOR EVIDENCE · Avoid jumping to advice until the root cause is clearer.

Source: The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

TOOL 1 · CONTINUED

Overinvest in Diagnosis:

Manager Tool Kit for Conducting a Root Cause Analysis



WIDEN THE LENS

C

4 CAREER

OBJECTIVE

Uncover how employees self-assess their strengths and weaknesses – and why they may not have focused on key development issues.

QUESTIONS TO TEST

- Which capabilities have been most critical to your success so far?
- Which current skills make you competitive as an external candidate?
- Which development gaps must you address before pursuing your career goals?

E

5 ENVIRONMENT

OBJECTIVE

Discover project management, workload, resourcing or communication issues that may be affecting performance.

QUESTIONS TO TEST

- Is it difficult to balance your priorities? Why?
- Does the organisation sufficiently support you to succeed in your role?
- Are you getting consistent messages from across the organisation?

DIAGNOSTIC HABIT

1. **Separate evidence from assumptions**
2. **Name the most likely cause**
3. **Ask the employee to correct your interpretation**

DIAGNOSE WITH THE EMPLOYEE – NOT ABOUT THEM.

Source: The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

TOOL 2

Employee Development Readiness Assessment

Clear career goal or aspiration	1	2	3	4	5
Interest in specific skills	1	2	3	4	5
Proficient in the current role	1	2	3	4	5
Applies new learning quickly	1	2	3	4	5
In a good place to take on more	1	2	3	4	5

1 Disagree 3 Neutral 5 Agree

Score after the conversation.

Record the evidence behind every rating.

Source: The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

TOOL 2

The score changes the development move

5 – 11

CURRENT ROLE

Coach and develop within the scope of current responsibilities.

12 – 18

STRETCH

Use a bounded stretch project or assignment with feedback.

19 – 25

ROTATION / NEW ROLE

Consider planned rotation, new-role experience or promotion.

Right-size the stretch. Development should challenge – not overwhelm or underuse.

Source: The Connector Manager (Roca & Wilde, 2019).

PERSONAL COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

Personal advantage sits where authenticity meets strategic value



Source: Dr Quyen Dang through experience and knowledge from different models

DETAILED FRAMEWORK

EDGE turns reflection into a focused growth strategy

Each stage produces a concrete coaching output for the employee.

E — EXPLORE PERSONAL ASSETS

Who am I – and what do I bring?

- Strengths and evidence
- Passions and energy
- Aspirations
- Experience and relationships
- Weaknesses to manage

PERSONAL ASSET PROFILE

D — DECODE STRATEGIC DEMAND

What will Zalo and stakeholders value?

- Organizational priorities
- Customer/stakeholder needs
- Future trends
- High-performer benchmarks
- Important unfilled gaps

STRATEGIC OPPORTUNITY MAP

G — GENERATE & TEST THE EDGE

What combination can make me distinctive?

Create advantage hypotheses, then test them:

V Valuable
R Rare
I Hard to imitate
F Future-relevant
A Authentic

COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE HYPOTHESIS

E — EXECUTE THE GROWTH STRATEGY

Where should I invest my effort?

DIFFERENTIATE
Strong + strategically valuable

BUILD
Gap + strategically valuable

MAINTAIN / DEPRIORITISE
Limited advantage potential

90-DAY GROWTH EXPERIMENT

PROFESSIONAL SIGNATURE
"When people need _____, I want them to think of me."

TEST THROUGH WORK • COLLECT EVIDENCE • REVIEW • REFINE

Source: Dr Quyen Dang through experience and knowledge from different models

The edge is a hypothesis strengthened through real assignments, relationships and evidence.

PAUSE · REFRESH · RECONNECT

Afternoon break

BACK AT 14:45

Stretch. Hydrate. Grab a coffee.

Next: Coaching Detective role-play

Come back ready to crack the coaching case.

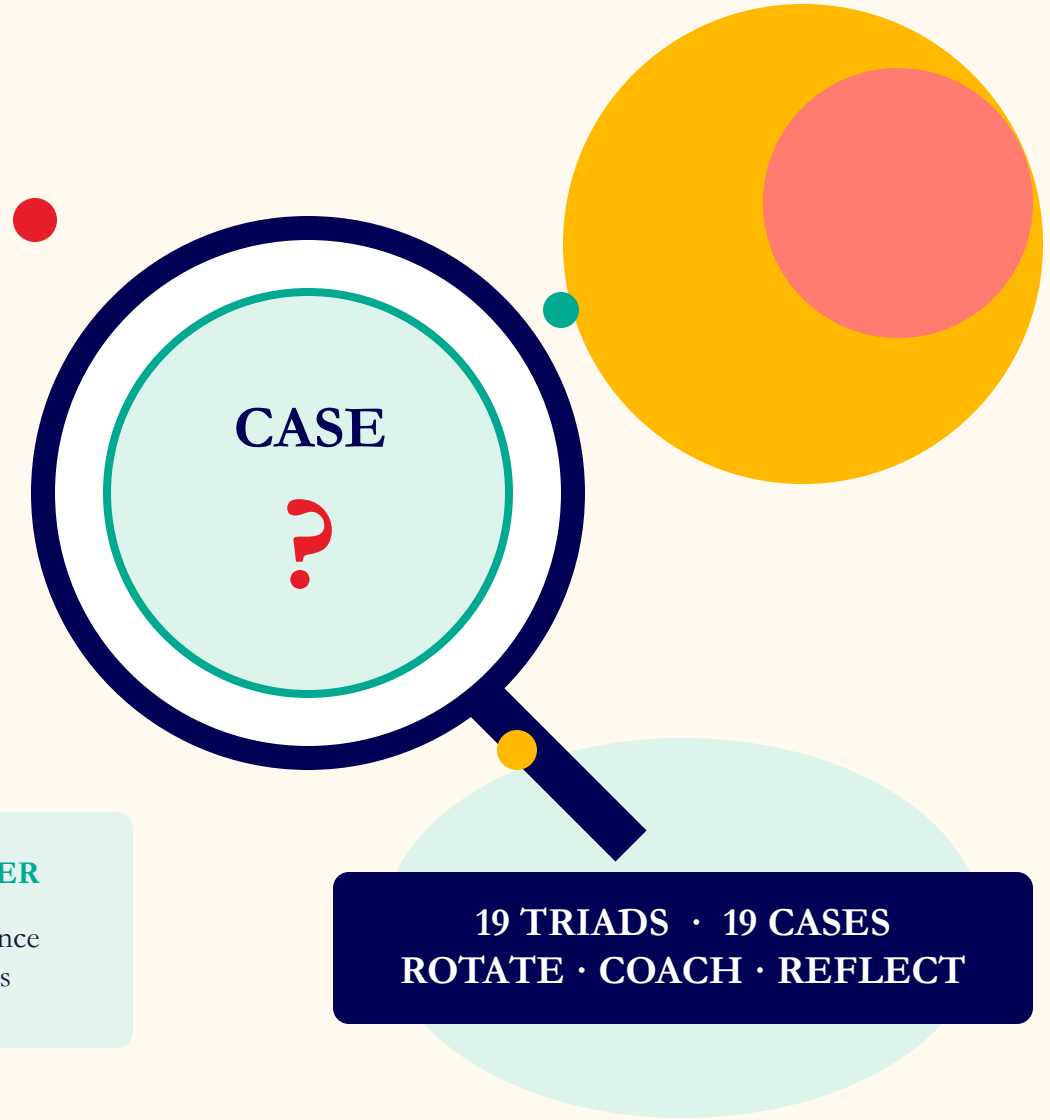


PART 5 · PRACTICE LAB

Coaching Detective

Crack the case. Don’t rescue it.

Listen for evidence, diagnose the real need and choose the right coaching response.



M — **MANAGER**
Coach and diagnose

E — **EMPLOYEE**
Bring the case to life

O — **OBSERVER**
Spot evidence and choices

30-SECOND DEMONSTRATION

The Late Dashboard

Watch how one rewind changes the diagnosis – and the development move.

MICRO-CASE

Huy, a product analyst, missed a dashboard deadline and says, "Maybe I need more Excel training."

REALITY

Product and Sales gave conflicting definitions for the same metric.

1

0 – 8 SEC

ADVICE REFLEX

Manager: "I'll send you an advanced Excel course and show you my dashboard template."

Facilitator: "Pause. What did the manager assume?"

2

8 – 24 SEC

REWIND

Manager: "Before we decide on training, what made the dashboard difficult this time?"

Huy: "Product and Sales define 'active user' differently, and I didn't know whose definition to use."

Listen for the evidence that changes the hypothesis.

3

24 – 30 SEC

DIAGNOSE

Manager: "So the main issue may be clarity and stakeholder alignment, not Excel. Who needs to agree the definition with you?"

Name the likely cause – then connect.

ASK THE ROOM

Which Tool 1 lens became more important?

Environment / knowledge clarity

1

What Connector move is emerging?

Connect Huy with the relevant Product and Sales owners – rather than prescribe training.

2

19-STATION CIRCUIT

Your triad moves; every case stays

One clockwise route keeps 19 stations complete and gives every learner three different cases.

57	19	19	3	1 → 2 → 3 → … → 18 → 19 → 1
LEARNERS	FIXED STATIONS	TRIADS OF 3	COACHING ROUNDS	

STAYS AT THE NUMBERED STATION

- Visible Manager Card + private Employee Card in its numbered envelope
- Three blank A3 Coaching Case Canvases begin here (57 total)
- Used Canvas and all station materials stay behind

TRAVELS WITH YOUR TRIAD

- Your personal Observer Scorecard (57 total) and personal notes
- All three people – moving together one station clockwise
- Room cues: visible countdown, route arrows and bell
- Optional: Detective Badge when the manager earns 5 of 6 evidence points

AT THE BELL

1 LEAVE

Cards, envelope, used Canvas and station materials behind.

2 TAKE

Only your personal scorecard and notes.

3 MOVE

Together, one station clockwise; Station 19 goes to 1.

4 ROTATE

A coaches Round 1; B Round 2; C Round 3. Wait for the timer.

WHY THIS WORKS **No case hand-offs. No duplicate destinations. Every station stays complete – and every triad experiences three different cases.**

THE D–R–C ROUTE

Diagnose → Readiness → Coach & Connect

Follow the evidence from the employee's story to a proportionate development move they own.

D DIAGNOSE

TOOL 1 · TEST FIVE HYPOTHESES

Knowledge • Skills • Motivation
Career • Environment

Separate facts from assumptions. Ask until the likely root cause is clearer.

OUTPUT Evidence-based root cause

R READINESS

TOOL 2 · RATE WHAT YOU HEARD

Rate all five statements 1–5 using evidence from the conversation – not intuition.

5 – 11 Current-role development
12 – 18 Stretch project or assignment
19 – 25 Rotation, new role or promotion

OUTPUT Proportionate development level

C COACH & CONNECT

CHOOSE THE MANAGER CONTRIBUTION

Coach where you can add value. If another source is better, connect the employee to a person, peer, team or organisational opportunity.
Close with ownership:
WHO will do WHAT – by WHEN?
Agree a follow-up point.

OUTPUT Employee-owned next move

THE ROUTE PROTECTS AGAINST PREMATURE ADVICE

Evidence first → readiness next → coaching and connection by fit → employee ownership

ROLE MATERIALS

One triad. Three distinct jobs.

Use only your assigned material – and protect the quality of the coaching conversation.

M MANAGER

MATERIALS

Manager Card +
Coaching Case Canvas

YOUR JOB

- Lead the conversation
- Record only short evidence words
- Complete the readiness assessment
- Agree the development move and next action

E EMPLOYEE

MATERIAL

Private Employee Card

YOUR JOB

- Keep your clues hidden
- Reveal a clue only when asked a relevant question
- Correct the Manager's interpretation when necessary

CD COACHING DETECTIVE

MATERIAL

Observer Scorecard

YOUR JOB

- Observe coaching behaviours
- Record specific examples
- Do not complete the Canvas for the Manager

ROLE BOUNDARY

The Manager owns the Canvas • The Employee owns the clues • The Detective owns the evidence

COACHING CASE CANVAS

Use the Canvas as a thinking aid – not a questionnaire

Three moments help you stay curious, capture evidence and close with employee ownership.

1 BEFORE THE CONVERSATION

2 MINUTES

WHAT TO DO

- Read the Manager Card
- Circle two possible root-cause hypotheses
- Do not decide the answer yet

2 DURING THE CONVERSATION

8 MINUTES

WHAT TO DO

- Use the five lenses flexibly
- Record only keywords
- Explore aspiration, capability and current capacity
- Do not administer the Canvas like a questionnaire

3 AT THE END

CLOSE

WHAT TO DO

- Summarise the likely root cause
- Check your understanding with the employee
- Complete the readiness assessment from evidence
- Agree the employee-owned action and follow-up

The Canvas guides your thinking – it does not replace the conversation.

RULES OF THE GAME

Three rules protect the coaching conversation

Stay curious long enough to find evidence – and leave the final move with the employee.

1

RULE 1

NO RESCUE MISSION

Do not offer a solution during the first three minutes.

WAIT 3 MINUTES

2

RULE 2

EVIDENCE, NOT ASSUMPTIONS

Every readiness rating must be supported by something the employee said.

CITE THE EVIDENCE

3

RULE 3

EMPLOYEE OWNERSHIP

The employee – not the Manager – must state the final action.

THE EMPLOYEE SAYS IT

?

EMPLOYEE CLUE RULE

Reveal a private clue only when the Manager asks a relevant question.

!

Premature advice may result in the temporary loss of your detective badge.

ONE ROUND = 16 MINUTES

Three rounds. Three roles. Three different cases.



Move clockwise together. Take only your personal Observer Scorecard and notes.

COACHING DETECTIVE SCORECARD

Observe six behaviours. Then make one moment better.

Score only what you hear or see – and anchor feedback in a specific example.

LOOK FOR SIX PIECES OF EVIDENCE

Mark ✓ only when you hear or see evidence. Add one short example.

- ☐ 1 Created a safe coaching opening
- ☐ 2 Diagnosed before giving advice
- ☐ 3 Explored the employee as a whole person
- ☐ 4 Assessed readiness using evidence
- ☐ 5 Chose an appropriate coaching or Connector move
- ☐ 6 Closed with employee ownership and follow-up

SCORE _____ / 6 ★ DETECTIVE BADGE · 5–6

GIVE FEEDBACK

Use the prompts in this order.

E EMPLOYEE

"I felt most coached when…"

O OBSERVER

"When you…, it helped or limited the conversation because…."

M MANAGER

Choose one moment to rewind and improve.

ROLE-PLAY DEBRIEF

Two questions turn practice into learning

1 What changed when the Manager diagnosed before giving advice?

2 How did readiness change the coaching move or connection you chose?

Curiosity before certainty • Evidence before scoring • Coach—do not rescue

CONNECTOR MANAGER ACTION PLAN

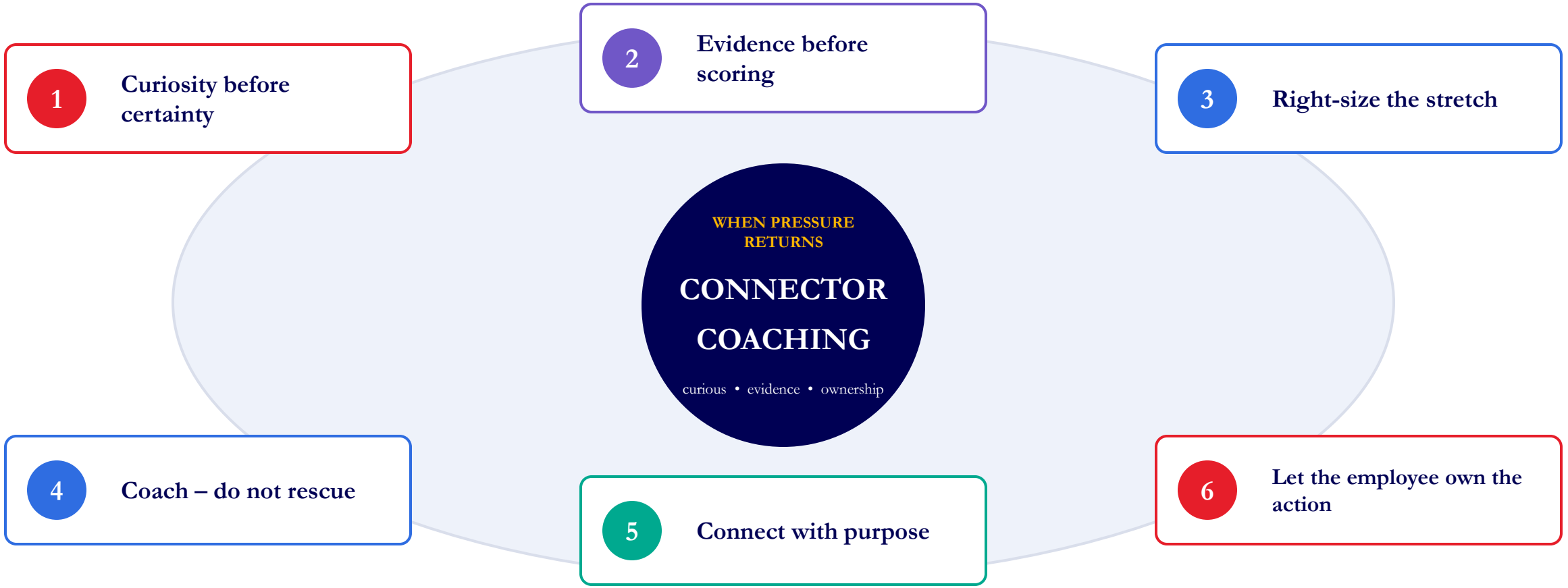
Turn today's insight into one seven-day experiment

1 CHOOSE	One employee and one real performance challenge.
2 DIAGNOSE	Likely root cause, evidence and readiness.
3 DECIDE	Coach directly or create an employee, team or organisation connection.
4 CONTRACT	Employee action, manager support and follow-up evidence.
5 COMMIT	**One action within seven days and one accountability partner.**

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Six habits to take back to work

When pressure returns, use these habits to stay in Connector mode.



SEVEN-DAY COMMITMENT

Turn one intention into a calendar action

Choose one real employee and one coaching action you will take within the next seven days.

1 → 2 → 3 → 4

WHO?

Choose one real employee.

WHAT?

Select one specific Connector coaching action.

WHEN?

Book the check-in within seven days.

COMMIT

Share with an accountability partner and take a photo.

WRITE YOUR COMMITMENT NOW

With _____, I will _____

on _____. I will know it worked when _____.

EXAMPLE

With Lan, I will diagnose before advising in Friday's 1:1. It worked if she states her own next action.

REFERENCES

The list below provides the references that were utilized to prepare today's session

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Ziesche S, Yampolskiy R (2020) Introducing the concept of ikigai to the ethics of AI and of human enhancements. *2020 IEEE International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Virtual Reality (AIVR)*. IEEE, 138–145.

THANK YOU

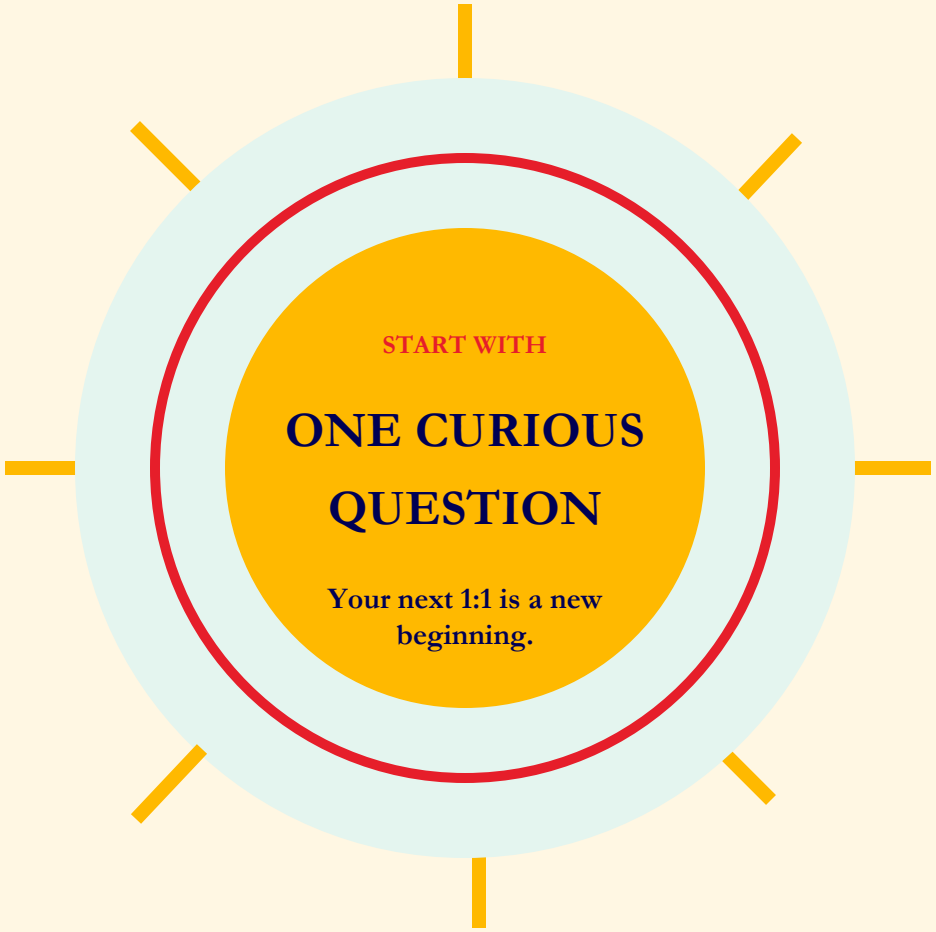
Thank you

The goal is not to have every answer.

MANAGERS CAN'T BE GREAT COACHES ALL BY THEMSELVES

Source: Harvard Business Review, May-June 2018, 22-24

Now go coach like a Connector – curious, selective and slightly less heroic.



→ **One employee. One better question. Within seven days.**